Nivolumab 3 mg/kg + ipilimumab 1 mg/kg — advanced melanoma

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00551 · Draft source reconciliation; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Taking or receiving treatment

During combination treatment, nivolumab 3 mg/kg is infused first over 30 minutes, then ipilimumab 1 mg/kg over 30 minutes. Maintenance may be nivolumab intravenous (IV) 240 mg every two weeks or IV 480 mg every four weeks, or the prescribed subcutaneous alternative of 600 mg every two weeks or 1200 mg every four weeks. In this melanoma source, IV 240 mg takes 30 minutes and IV 480 mg takes 60 minutes; subcutaneous administration takes about three to five minutes.

STEP 2

Missed, vomited or held treatment

If a dose is delayed or held, obtain a revised written plan. The first two-weekly maintenance dose starts three weeks after the last combination dose; the first four-weekly dose starts six weeks afterwards. Do not calculate a different start from the maintenance interval alone. Earlier immune toxicity and permanent-stop decisions still apply.

STEP 3

Appointments and supply

Before each visit, check four things: the blood-test booking, how you will get there, your medicine supply and any help you need. Ask who will review the results and tell you whether the next dose can go ahead.

STEP 4

Paper copies and contacts

Keep the handbook, short guide and treatment card in one place. Ask your team to fill in the real daytime and emergency numbers and print a replacement when the plan changes. A phone is optional.

Sources: NCCP 00551 v7a: current regimen source. Draft source reconciliation; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.